

United States. High Commissioner to the Philippine Islands. 1941. *Annual Report of the United States High Commissioner to the Philippine Islands Commissioner to the Philippine Islands Covering the Calendar Year 1941*. Washington: U.S. G.P.O. Accessed December 4, 2020. <https://archive.org/details/annualreportofun4041unit/page/112/mode/2up>

Prior to the Japanese occupation, several documents from the U.S. government and the Philippine Commonwealth had written on the conditions of preparedness in the Philippines should the Second World War encroach the Pacific. The US High Commissioner to the Philippines included in his reports the wartime preparations in various aspects such as public safety, relief and refuge from the attacks that would eventually ensue. Treatment from injuries in the several attacks during the wartime became difficult due to the scarcity of resources such as medicine and other supplies.

The excerpt below is taken from a section on public safety and health which were among several wartime instructions to armed forces and civilian troops. It highlighted the role of the Philippine Red Cross to be in-charge of first-aid units during the attacks. These instructions from the government show the immediate treatments during bombs as well as decontamination instructions from chemicals that was obtained in these attacks.

EXCERPT:

FIRST-AID UNITS

First-aid units will be organized on the basis of four persons and one automobile with driver to each party. Two ambulances with drivers and two attendants for each ambulance will form an integral part of such units. Where regular ambulances are not available, they should be improvised from suitable motor vehicles in the locality. A sufficient number of these units will be organized in each community so as to provide a minimum of one such unit to each 3,000 of population or major fraction thereof.

The Philippine Red Cross will be responsible for the organization and training of all first aid units.

The instruction of such units should include the treatment of shock, hemorrhage, fractures, unconsciousness, suffocation, electric shock, and burns and scalds, as contained in the

usual first-aid course of instruction. In addition to this, instructions must be given in the proper treatment of gas casualties. Such instructions are briefly summarized below :

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Localized areas of contamination on the body caused by blister gas (mustard) should be treated by removing the blister gas from the skin by using gasoline, alcohol, or naphtha as a solvent. To apply these solvents a small piece of cotton batting should be held between the finger and the thumb, only the end of it being dipped in the solvent. Rubber gloves, if available, should be worn while applying the solvent. It is important to avoid spreading the blister gas by rubbing or using an excess of solvent. Solvents only remove the blister gas — they do not destroy it. For this reason a succession of swabs should be used, and the contaminated swabs burnt or buried. If the above solvents are not readily available, the affected part should be thoroughly washed with soap and water. In all cases where there has been contamination it is advisable for the casualty to be washed completely with soap and water, in addition to the solvent treatment described above for the affected part. It must be emphasized that the success of any method of preventive treatment depends upon the promptness with which it is applied.

Lung Irritant Gas

Whether symptoms are present or not, any person who has been exposed to a lung irritant gas must, from the outset, be spared any further exertion. He must be kept lying down and be protected from chill. He should be removed as a stretcher case.

Eye Irritant Gas

Face the wind with the eyes open. Do not rub the eyes under any circumstances. If it is available, wash the eyes with a weak solution of boric acid. First-aid stations for the treatment of ambulatory cases will be established in each community. The personnel and equipment for these stations will be trained and furnished by the Philippine Red Cross. These stations will be located in such places and in such numbers as not to require an injured person to walk any great distance. Existing hospitals will be expanded, and buildings suitable for hospitals will be selected for use as hospitals whenever present facilities are inadequate. The Philippine Red Cross is responsible for the determination of the adequacy of existing facilities and for arranging for their expansion where deemed necessary. The Philippine Red Cross is also responsible for the securing of additional buildings suitable for hospitals whenever present facilities prove inadequate. Doctors, nurses, hospital attendants and other personnel will be procured by the Philippine Red Cross.

In each municipality rescue units will be formed whose duties are to rescue persons trapped in fallen buildings and in debris from such buildings. Each unit will consist of a leader and eight men, all of whom will be recruited from men skilled in the building trades. Rescue work requires a special knowledge of the method of handling and storing up debris in order to prevent injury to the persons being rescued and to the members of the rescue units. Rescue units will be organized by, trained by, and operate under, the district and city engineers. One such unit will be organized for each 6,000 of population or major fraction thereof. Tools and equipment for the use of these units will be provided by the local authorities.

DEMOLITION AND REPAIR UNITS

Units to handle demolitions and repair will, be organized in each community. The duties of such units are to clear streets of their wreckage, fill bomb craters, assist when necessary in the repair of damaged water and gas mains, sewers, electric transmission lines, etc. They also will cooperate with fire-fighting units when it becomes necessary to use explosives on or otherwise demolish structures in order to prevent the spread of fire and to bring a fire under control. The personnel of these units should be recruited from persons skilled in construction work, the handling and use of explosives, street and highway repair, and general utilities repair and maintenance. These units will be organized by, trained by, and operate under, the district and city engineers. The strength and composition of each unit and the number of units in each locality will be determined by the district or city engineer after consideration of the installations to be maintained in each case.

DECONTAMINATION UNITS

Units formed for the purpose of decontaminating areas in which poisoned gas has been used will be organized in each community under the direction of district and city engineers. Each unit will consist of a leader and six men. One unit will be formed for each 5,000 of population or major portion thereof. While such units should be trained in the approved methods of decontaminating gassed areas, they also should be trained to assist in rescue, demolition, or repair work. The first step taken by these units will be to work out, with danger signs and barriers, the contaminated areas. No unauthorized persons should be allowed to enter these areas. Decontamination work should then begin promptly. The following materials may be used for decontaminating work:

- a. Earth. Earth, sand, ashes, or sawdust may be spread over a contaminated area to provide temporary protection. The layer of covering material should be at least 3 inches thick and will be much more effective if wet down with water. The

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chemical used in the gas is not destroyed by this procedure but the covering layer will prevent the escape of further poisonous vapors.

- b. Water. Some gases are readily decomposed by water, and a liberal wetting of the contaminated area is sufficient to destroy them. With some gases such as mustard, water has no neutralizing effect. Therefore, even long after an area has been washed with water it is dangerous to sit or lie down therein. If practicable, the area should be covered with a 3-inch layer of earth, sand, or ashes. Whenever it is available, chloride of lime should be used as indicated below.
- c. Chloride of lime. This is a white powder which readily gives up its chlorine content when exposed to the air or moisture. It should be kept in air-tight containers and used immediately after removal from them. It combines quickly with blister gases (mustard) and if it is mixed with sand or earth no violent reaction will occur. The proportions should be about one part of chloride of lime to three parts of sand or earth. One pound of chloride of lime is required for each square yard of gassed area. In decontaminating machinery, woodwork of buildings, etc., chloride of lime generally can be more easily and effectively applied in liquid form with rags, swabs, or brushes. The solution used should consist of one part of chloride of lime to one part of hot water.
- d. Fire. An area covered with high dry grass or brush may be decontaminated by burning it, provided this can be done without danger to nearby personnel or property. The heat in many instances will cause a heavy cloud of mustard vapor to be given off down-wind during the burning.

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Vargas, Jorge. *Report of Philippine (Executive Commission) to the Director, J.M.A. Jorge B. Manila: 1943*

As the designated executive secretary of President Laurel, Vargas was tasked to create annual reports on the activities of the Philippine Government to the Imperial Japanese forces. This report of the Executive Committee consists of activities ranging from economic programs to address scarcity of resources to wartime propaganda through public instruction and cultural activities

The excerpt below shows the efforts by the provisional government to use education and public instruction for propaganda. These areas included the expansive utilization of Japanese and Filipino as languages as the provisional government. Cultural activities such as lectures from different experts on Filipino and Japanese culture and propaganda films were also used to spread

the idea of the wider imperial vision of Japan, the Greater East Asia Co-Prosperity Sphere to Filipinos.

EXCERPT:

For the purpose of giving spiritual and intellectual reorientation to ranking employees in the different bureaus and offices, a government employees training institute was organized on October 15, 1943, and the first term of training was started on October 19, 1942. The Supervision of the Institute was placed under the Executive Secretary to the Commission and its administration under the Chief of the Civil Service.

During the first term, October 19 to December 14, 1942, 199 trainees were enrolled; during the second term, January 10 to March 15, 1945, a total of 395 employees were graduated.

The curriculum of instruction approved for the Institute and consisting of the following studies was carefully followed: General Information Concerning Japan; Public Service Administration; Japanese Language; Philippine Culture; Music Japanese and Filipino songs; Physical culture; and Lectures on various topics to the New Order, the intentions of Nippon in waging the Greater East Asia War, the development of the Greater East Asia Co-Prosperity Sphere, the establishment of the New Philippines, and others. To supplement the regular classroom instruction there was provided a series of lectures by prominent and distinguished Nipponese and Filipino government officials and scholars, moving pictures shows consisting of both recreational and instructional files.

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“Letter of President Quezon to Douglas MacArthur, February 20, 1942.” *Official Gazette*.
<https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1942/02/20/letter-of-president-quezon-to-douglas-macarthur-february-20-1942/>

During the war, President Manuel L. Quezon along with his several key official of the Philippine Commonwealth fled from the Philippines and remained in the United States until 1944. Quezon executed most of his duties and responsibilities as president.

Below is his letter to General Douglas MacArthur, the head of the United States Army Forces in the Far East. It contains personal words to General McArthur written in personal correspondence beyond his issuance of Executive Order No. I, series of 1942, which appointed General MacArthur as the Military Adviser of the Commonwealth of the Philippines.

EXCERPT:

Fort Mills, P.I.

February 20, 1942

My dear General MacArthur:

Although I have given official recognition to the services you have rendered to the government of the Commonwealth and to the Filipino people in my Executive Order No. I, series of 1942, I feel that I must write you this letter, which partakes of an official as well as private character, in order to tell you how grateful I am, my own family, and the members of my whole staff for the kindness and generosity with which we have been treated here; and to ask you to convey to all the officers within your command, particularly to General Moore, our deep gratitude.

As I have already told you, I would have remained here to the very bitter end, if you deemed it necessary for me to stay. I am going only because you and I have agreed that the cause for which we are fighting can be best promoted by my being in the unoccupied territory where I could render you help and assistance by keeping up the morale and determination of my people to stand by America. But I am leaving you with a weeping heart, for you and I have not only been friends and comrades; we have been more than brothers. My thoughts will always be with you and your dear wife and my godson. If better days should come to all of us, as I hope they will, I expect that the memory of these hectic days will strengthen our friendship and cooperation even more. I am leaving my own boys, the Filipino soldiers, under your care. I know that you will look after their welfare and safety and that, above all, you will see to it that their names may go down in history as loyal and brave soldiers.

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With my love to you, Jean and the boy, in which all my family joins, I say good-bye till we meet again. May God ever keep you under His protection.

Sincerely yours,

(Sgd.) Manuel Quezon

“Message of General MacArthur to the Filipino people, January 1, 1946.” *Official Gazette*.

<https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1946/01/01/message-of-douglas-macarthur-to-the-filipino-people-january-1-1946/>

Douglas MacArthur was the head of the United States Army Forces in the Far East or USAFFE from 1941 to 1946. In the Philippines during the Second World War, President Quezon appointed General MacArthur as the Military Adviser of the Commonwealth of the Philippines. MacArthur led the efforts for the defense of the Philippines at the onset of the Pacific War in 1941. Upon the defeat of US and Philippine forces in the early year of the war, he escaped the Philippines in 1942, and continued with efforts to defend Allied Forces in the Asia-Pacific.

In July 1944, MacArthur returned in the Philippines in the landing of Leyte Gulf, where he is quoted to have said, “I have returned,” one of his wartime promises to head the efforts liberate

the Philippines from the Japanese forces. Below is his message to the Filipino people towards the end of the Second World War.

EXCERPT:

**Message
of
General Douglas MacArthur
Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers
To the Filipino People**

[Released on January 1, 1946]

Tokyo, 1946

To the Filipino People:

With the dawn of a new year—a year of peace following the ravage of war—I send you from Tokyo a message of my enduring affection. I can never forget the courage, the determination and the unity with which you fought your way to victory.

Confronted with the pressing problems of building anew amid the ruins left in war's wake, and at the same time entering upon your destiny as a member of the Nations of the World, you face a

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task the magnitude of which demands the dedication of all of your faith and all of your strength as a people.

Move forward to meet this challenge of the future as magnificently as you met that of the past. With continued help of Almighty God, in this noble purpose, I know you will not fail.

DOUGLAS MACARTHUR

“Message of President Osmeña to the Filipino people on V-J Day, September 2, 1945.”

***Official Gazette.* <https://www.officialgazette.gov.ph/1945/09/02/statement-of-president-osmena-to-the-filipino-people-on-v-j-day-september-2-1945/>**

Sergio Osmeña Sr. was the second President of the Commonwealth of the Philippines, who succeeded Manuel L. Quezon in 1944. President Osmeña accompanied U.S. General Douglas MacArthur, several ranking officers in the U.S. forces and key officials in Philippine Commonwealth in the liberation of the Philippines. Among his key priorities were the reorganization of the government and rehabilitation after war.

The document below shows the message of President Osmeña to mark the Victory over Japanese Day or V-J Day after the surrender of the Japanese Empire to the Allied Forces.

EXCERPT:

**Message of His Excellency Sergio Osmeña
President of the Philippines To the Filipino People on V-J Day**

[Released on September 2, 1945]

With the formal surrender of the Japanese Empire today, September 2, 1945, the long and terrible war is at an end. President Truman, speaking on behalf of all the United Nations, has proclaimed this day as V-J Day.

The surrender of Japan marks the turning point for us and for the peoples of all the United Nations.

Our effort has been devoted toward the paramount task of winning the war. Today the task is done. We must now devote ourselves to the task of winning the peace.

On the indestructible democratic foundations laid under the tutelage of America we must reconstruct and build. The rehabilitation of our country demands all our energies.

We must prepare for the independence which will soon be ours and, as members of the family of nations, we must work with other peoples in the effort to assure the peace and welfare of humanity. For our people we may hope to achieve a greater and lasting happiness.

Today is a day of thanksgiving in the flush of victory. It should also be a day of dedication to the heavy tasks that lie before us.

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“Instrument of Surrender of the Japanese and Japanese-Controlled Armed Forces in the Philippine Islands to the Commanding General United States Army Forces, Western Pacific” *Lillian Goldman Law Library*. Yale University Accessed December 4, 2020. <https://avalon.law.yale.edu/wwii/j6.asp>

Tomoyuki Yamashita was a Japanese general of the Imperial Japanese Army assigned to areas mostly in Southeast Asia. After being deployed to Malaya and Singapore, he was assigned to defend the Philippines from the Allied forces in 1944. Under his command, the Japanese army committed atrocities, some of which were basis for the U.S. Supreme Court's 1946 decision to execute him.

The document below shows the surrender of Yamahista to US Major General Edmond H. Leavy. Even after the formal surrender of Japan in August 1945, he was able to hold on to part of Luzon in September 1944.

EXCERPT:

INSTRUMENT OF SURRENDER

of the Japanese and Japanese-Controlled Armed Forces in the Philippine
Islands to the Commanding General United States Army Forces, Western
Pacific

Camp John Hay

Baguio, Mountain Province,

Luzon, Philippine, Islands

3 September, 1945

Pursuant to and in accordance with the proclamation of the Emperor of Japan accepting the terms set forth in the declaration issued by the heads of the Governments of the United States, Great Britain, and China on 26 July 1945; at Potsdam and subsequently adhered to by the Union of
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Soviet Socialist Republics; and to the formal instrument of surrender of the Japanese Imperial Government and the Japanese Imperial General Headquarters signed at Tokyo Bay at 0908 on 2 September 1945:

1. Acting by command of and in behalf of the Emperor of Japan, the Japanese Imperial Government and the Japanese Imperial General Headquarters, We hereby surrender unconditionally to the Commanding General, United States Army Forces, Western Pacific, all Japanese and Japanese-controlled armed forces, air, sea, ground and auxiliary, in the Philippine Islands.

2. We hereby command all Japanese forces wherever situated in the Philippine Islands to cease hostilities forthwith, to preserve and save from damage all ships, aircraft, and military and civil property, and to comply with all requirements which may be imposed by the Commanding General, United States Army Forces, Western Pacific, or his authorized representatives.

3. We hereby direct the commanders of all Japanese forces in the Philippine Islands to issue at once to all forces under their command to surrender unconditionally themselves and all forces under their control, as prisoners of war, to the nearest United States Force Commander.

4. We hereby direct the commanders of all Japanese forces in the Philippine Islands to surrender intact and in good order to the nearest United States Army Force Commander, at times and at places directed by him, all equipment and supplies of whatever nature under their control.

5. We hereby direct the commanders of all Japanese forces in the Philippine Islands at once to liberate all Allied prisoners of war and civilian internees under their control, and to provide for their protection, care, maintenance and immediate transportation to places as directed by the nearest United States Army Force Commander.

6. We hereby undertake to transmit the directives given in Paragraphs 1 through 5, above, to all Japanese forces in the Philippine Islands immediately by all means within our power, and further to furnish to the Commanding General, United States Army Forces, Western Pacific, all necessary Japanese emissaries fully empowered to bring about the surrender of Japanese forces in the Philippine Islands with whom we are not in contact.

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7. We hereby undertake to furnish immediately to the Commanding General, United States Army Forces, Western Pacific, a statement of the designation, numbers, locations, and commanders of all Japanese armed forces, ground, sea, or air, in the Philippine Islands.

8. We hereby undertake faithfully to obey all further proclamation, orders and directives deemed by the Commanding General, United States Armed Forces, Western Pacific, to be proper to effectuate this surrender.

Signed at Camp John Hay, Baguio, Mountain Province, Luzon, Philippine Islands, at 1210 hours
3 September 1945:

TOMOYUKI YAMASHITA,
General, Imperial Japanese
Army Highest Commander,
Imperial Japanese Army in the Philippines.

DENHICI OKOCHI,
Vice Admiral, Imperial Japanese
Navy, Highest Commander,
Imperial Japanese Navy in the Philippines.

By command and in behalf
of the Japanese Imperial
General Headquarters

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Accepted at Camp John Hay, Baguio, Mountain Province Luzon
Philippine Islands, at 1210 hours 3 September 1945:
For the Commander-in-Chief, United States Army Forces, Pacific:

EDMOND H. LEAVY,
Major General, USA
Deputy Commander, United States Army Forces,
Western Pacific.